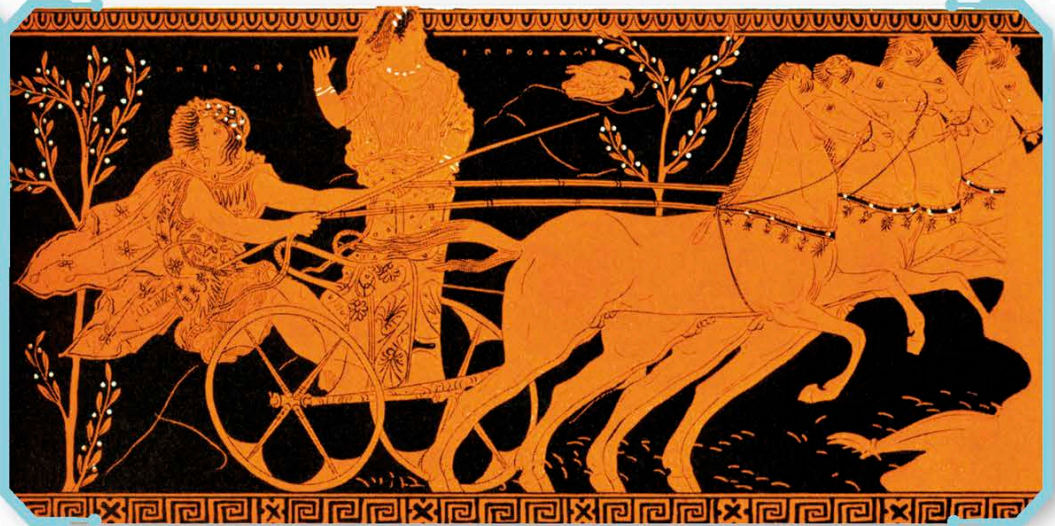


Pelops and Hippodamia

The carvings on the east side of the temple show the story of Pelops and Hippodamia. Pelops won Hippodamia's hand in marriage after winning a chariot race. He is said to have founded the Olympic Games after his victory. In this image, Pelops has Hippodamia in his chariot.



Zeus holds a statue of Nike, goddess of victory, in his right hand.

In his left hand Zeus holds a scepter topped with an eagle.

Nike of Paionios

Nike was the goddess of victory. This statue of her was reconstructed from fragments found by archaeologists in 1875. Nike is shown as a winged woman in flight, with her clothing blowing around her. The statue was nearly 6½ ft (2 m) tall. It was made from marble and might once have been painted.

Only parts of Nike's arms have been found.



Wonder of the world

In the 20th century, fragments of the clay molds used to make the Statue of Zeus were excavated from the famous sculptor Phidias's workshop at Olympia. This statue became known as one of the seven wonders of the world. After the ancient Olympic Games ended, the statue was acquired by the Romans; it ended up in the city of Constantinople, where it was later destroyed by fire.

The great statue of Zeus is 42 ft (13 m) high.

The shapes used to create the folds in Zeus' garments can be seen in the mold.

